Start a New Zend Framework 2 Project

XAMPP makes it easy to start developing with PHP, and Zend Framework 2 is one of the most popular PHP development frameworks. This guide walks you through the process of initializing a new Zend Framework 2 project with XAMPP.

NOTE

This guide uses the command-line git client for Mac OS X. If you don't already have this, you can install it easily by running the command *brew install git* from your terminal. It also assumes that the new Zend Framework 2 application will be accessible at the URL http://localhost/myapp/.

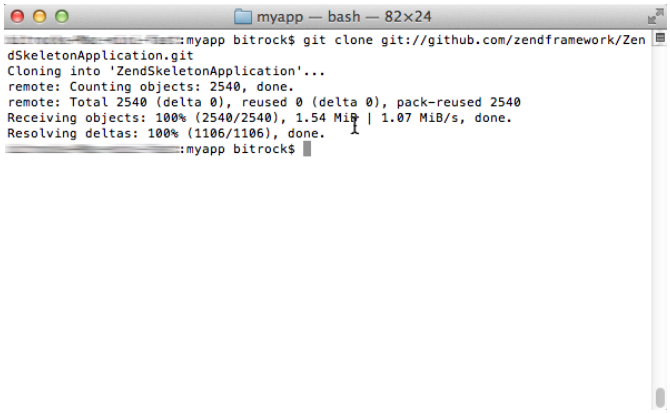
Follow these steps:

1. Open a new terminal and ensure you are logged in as administrator.
2. Within your XAMPP installation directory (usually */Applications/XAMPP/xamppfiles/*), create a new directory named *apps/* (if it doesn't already exist). Then, within this new *apps/* directory, create a directory to hold your Zend Framework application and its related XAMPP configuration files. In this case, call the directory *myapp/*.

   ```
   cd /Applications/XAMPP/xamppfiles/
   mkdir apps
   mkdir apps/myapp
   ```

3. Clone the Zend Framework 2 sample application repository to the *myapp/* directory using *git*.

   ```
   cd /Applications/XAMPP/xamppfiles/apps/myapp
   git clone git://github.com/zendframework/ZendSkeletonApplication.git
   ```

   This will produce a *ZendSkeletonApplication/* subdirectory in the *myapp/* directory. Rename this newly-created subdirectory to *htdocs*.

   ```
   cd /Applications/XAMPP/xamppfiles/apps/myapp/
   mv ZendSkeletonApplication htdocs
   ```

   NOTE This will be the main working directory for your Zend Framework 2 project.

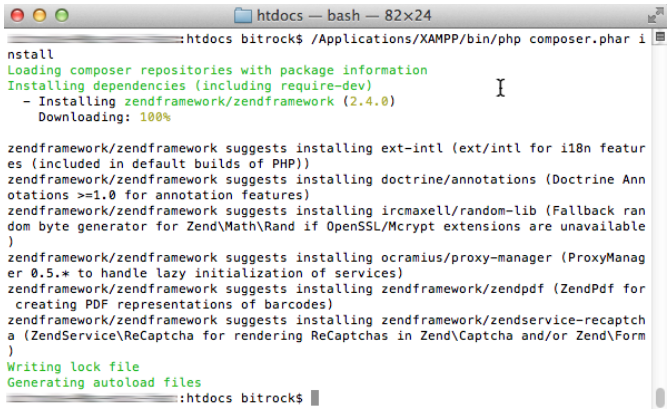
4. Change to the *myapp/htdocs/* directory and run the following commands to update Composer (the PHP dependency manager) and install the Zend Framework 2 components.

```
cd /Applications/XAMPP/xamppfiles/apps/myapp/htdocs
/Applications/XAMPP/bin/php composer.phar self-update
/Applications/XAMPP/bin/php composer.phar install
```

In case you encounter SSL errors when running the above commands, update the */Applications/XAMPP/etc/php.ini* file and add the *openssl.cafile* variable to let PHP know where to find your system's SSL certificates, then try again.

```
openssl.cafile=/Applications/XAMPP/xamppfiles/share/curl/curl-ca-bundle.crt
```

Here's an example of what you might see as Composer downloads and installs dependencies.



5. Next, within the *myapp/* directory, create a new conf/ subdirectory.

```
cd /Applications/XAMPP/xamppfiles/apps/myapp
mkdir conf
```

   a. Within the new *conf/* subdirectory, use your text editor to create and populate a file named *httpd-prefix.conf* with the following content:

```
Alias /myapp/ "/Applications/XAMPP/xamppfiles/apps/myapp/htdocs/public/"
Alias /myapp "/Applications/XAMPP/xamppfiles/apps/myapp/htdocs/public"
Include "/Applications/XAMPP/xamppfiles/apps/myapp/conf/httpd-app.conf"
```

   b. Within the *conf/* subdirectory, also create and populate a file named *httpd-app.conf* with the following content:

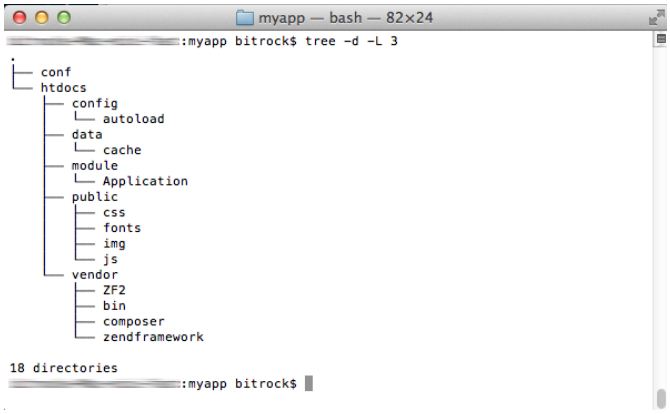
```
<Directory /Applications/XAMPP/xamppfiles/apps/myapp/htdocs/public>
  Options +FollowSymLinks
  AllowOverride All
  Require all granted
</Directory>
```

6. Edit the *httpd-xampp.conf* file in the *etc/extra/* subdirectory of your XAMPP installation directory and add the following line at the end to include the *httpd-prefix.conf* created earlier.

```
Include "/Applications/XAMPP/xamppfiles/apps/myapp/conf/httpd-prefix.conf"
```

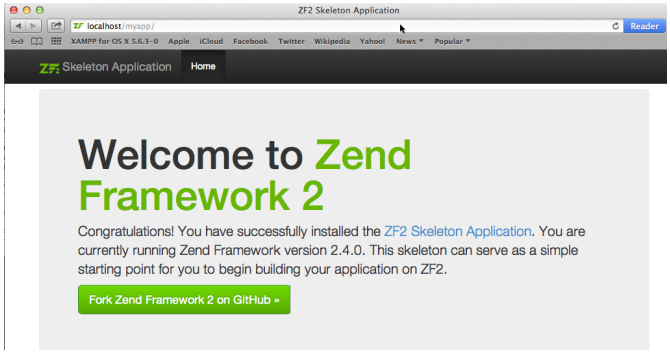
> **NOTE** Remember to update the above file and directory paths so that they're valid for your system.

7. Check that you have a directory structure like this:



8. Restart the Apache server using the XAMPP control panel.

9. You should now be able to access the Zend Framework 2 skeleton application by browsing to http://localhost/myapp. Here is an example of the default welcome page you should see:



You can now begin developing your Zend Framework 2 application by modifying the skeleton application code. For more information, refer to the Zend Framework 2 User Guide.